

Workbook 2 - Persona Reflective Exercise Answers

1. CONFIRM THE PROBLEM (You are trying to solve)

- **Instruction Summary:** Traditional TRPGs suffer from a severe shortage of human Game Masters due to heavy prep work (3–5 hours of prep for a 3-hour session), complex rulebooks that overwhelm beginners, and a lack of lightweight online platforms built for friend groups to play together seamlessly.

2. CREATE PERSONAS (Based on user research and interviews)

- **PERSONA 1: The Novice Adventurer (Alex, 21)**
 - *Background:* College student and fantasy game fan. Eager to try tabletop role-playing games with close friends, but completely intimidated by hundreds of pages of complex rulebooks and character sheet math. Wants an easy, welcoming entry point without steep learning curves.
- **PERSONA 2: The Burned-Out Game Master (David, 28)**
 - *Background:* Experienced GM who loves running stories for his friend group. However, he spends 4 to 5 hours every week writing plots, drawing maps, and balancing stats, leading to severe burnout and a lack of time to actually enjoy the game himself.
- **PERSONA 3: The Friend-First Co-op Player (Chloe, 24)**
 - *Background:* Busy working professional who loves hanging out and gaming online with her tight-knit circle of 4 friends via voice chat. She needs a lightweight, cross-platform session tool that lets them jump into a continuous shared story instantly on weekends without scheduling headaches.

3. IDENTIFY PERSONAS' CHALLENGES (Write "how could we help" questions)

- **PERSONA 1's CHALLENGES:**
 - *Frustrations:* Overwhelmed by complicated rulebooks; scared of making mistakes during character creation; doesn't know where to start.
 - *"How could we help?":* **How could we help** beginners instantly start playing without reading heavy rulebooks, using system guidance and automated character creation?
- **PERSONA 2's CHALLENGES:**
 - *Frustrations:* Exhausted by hours of manual prep work; lacks the free time to design maps and manage complex campaign lore.
 - *"How could we help?":* **How could we help** burnt-out Game Masters eliminate prep stress by letting an AI handle NPC reactions, world generation, and story pacing?
- **PERSONA 3's CHALLENGES:**
 - *Frustrations:* Hard to coordinate schedules; current tools are clunky or built for local single-players rather than online friend group hangouts.
 - *"How could we help?":* **How could we help** close friend groups easily team up across devices (PC, mobile, web) to enjoy persistent, long-term shared storytelling together?

4. SELECT YOUR BEST IDEA (...for solving each persona's challenges)

- **PERSONA 1's SOLUTION:**

- *Selected Idea: **AI-Guided Onboarding & Automated Character Creation.*** A simple conversational interface where players describe their dream hero in plain English, and the system automatically generates character stats and rule-checks.

- **PERSONA 2's SOLUTION:**

- *Selected Idea: **The AI Game Master (AI DM) Engine.*** A smart assistant that instantly generates dynamic story paths, environment descriptions, and NPC dialogues on the fly, reducing a GM's prep time from hours to zero.

- **PERSONA 3's SOLUTION:**

- *Selected Idea: **Cross-Platform Friend-Party Room with a Rule-Engineered World.*** A cloud-based collaborative platform where friends can join via web or mobile links, sharing a single persistent world that tracks all their choices fairly.

5. DESCRIBE YOUR IDEA (How it works, Process, Screens, 3D Model, etc.)

- **PERSONA 1's DETAILS ON SOLUTION:**

- *How it works:* When Alex logs in for the first time, a friendly assistant guides them through a quick chat. Instead of rolling stats manually, Alex types: "I want to be a clever elf archer." The AI instantly builds the character sheet and introduces a short, gentle prologue to teach the rules naturally.

- **PERSONA 2's DETAILS ON SOLUTION:**

- *How it works:* David selects a pre-made or custom world template. Instead of writing custom notes for hours, he lets the AI DM handle real-time environment descriptions and rules adjudication using function calling, allowing David to play alongside his friends as a regular player or oversee the story effortlessly.

- **PERSONA 3's DETAILS ON SOLUTION:**

- *How it works:* Chloe creates a "Friend Room" link with one click and shares it in her group chat. Her friends join instantly from their phones or laptops. As the team makes wild, free-form choices, the backend rule engine locks in the consequences, updating their shared digital world permanently for future sessions.